

# Industry News

## Mobile number portability extended

The Department of Telecommunications (DoT) has extended the date for implementation of the first phase of mobile number portability in metro and category-A service areas till 31st December. Mobile number portability would enable mobile users to retain their mobile numbers even after changing service providers.

The DoT has extended the date in view of time and efforts required to customise and upgrade the existing networks for enabling them to provide the mobile number portability service. Moreover, certain technical and commercial issues relating to the service are also to be resolved.

Initially, the expected date for implementation was 20th September. Syniverse Technologies (Zone 1) and MNP Interconnection (Zone 2) are the two companies that have been awarded a licence by the DoT to implement the mobile number portability service.

## Cyber cafes can increase Internet penetration

With a billion plus population, only 6.8 million people in India are using broadband and the figures for Inter-

## Dhoot takes over as CMAI chairman

The Communications and Manufacturing Association of India (CMAI) has appointed Venugopal N. Dhoot as chairman and Ravi Sharma as executive chairman. Dhoot serves as the chairman of Videcon Industries Ltd.

CMAI is a telecom industry association representing all stakeholders including operators, manufacturers, infrastructure providers and operators, system integrators, value-added service providers, etc.

## Suri to head Nokia Siemens

Nokia Siemens Networks CEO Simon Beresford-Wylie has stepped down from his post. Replacing Simon, Rajeev Suri, an Indian citizen, will take the helm at the company. Suri, who currently leads the services business of Nokia Siemens, will now be based at the company's headquarters in Espoo, Finland.

Suri brings 20 years of experience in the telecommunications industry to the role of chief executive officer.

## Bana joins Alcatel-Lucent India

Alcatel-Lucent has named Subhash Bana as vice president, R&D. In this

role, Bana will be responsible for driving excellence in engineering performance across the carrier and applications software activities, including R&D service delivery, quality and innovation enhancing support to the Indian customers. He will also liaise with the business divisions to develop and execute products and solutions for emerging markets.

Bana will report to Vivek Mohan, managing director, Alcatel-Lucent India. Prior to this appointment, he was vice president of Thomson's operations in India and Sri Lanka.

## Dogra is now GM, EMG, Agilent India

Arun Dogra has been appointed as the new general manager for the electronics measurement group (EMG) of Agilent India. Prior to this promotion, he was the director of EMG Global Business Services.

Dogra had joined Agilent in March 2002, where he established and managed R&D operations in India. He pioneered shared services model for Global Business Services out of India. This function now supports Agilent EMG sales, support, services and quality on worldwide basis.

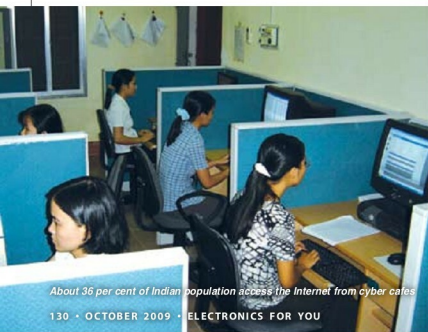
net users vary from 60 to 70 million. The reasons behind this include low PC penetration, high cost of PCs and hardware, and limited service offerings.

With about 36 per cent of the Indian population accessing the Internet from cyber cafes, their immense reach is yet to be exploited to the

hilt. There is excellent opportunity for cyber cafes especially in Tier 2 and 3 cities of India, provided all the pieces of the value chain are in place. The cyber cafes, in future, will become the primary means for a large section of urban and semi-urban residents to access the plethora of e-Governance services. These from being merely an Internet browsing point can become centres offering services like Internet telephony, video conferencing, localised content and remote surveillance.

## Kerala to become 100 per cent e-literate

Come November, all villages in Kerala will have access to high-speed



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